

PDF 3: TENNIS

Page 1: Introduction, History & Overview

TENNIS

The Elegant Racket Sport

Introduction

Tennis is a popular racket sport played between two players (singles) or two teams of two players each (doubles). The goal is to serve a ball using a racket to the opponent's side in such a way that the opponent cannot return it. Players must keep the ball in play, and it can only bounce once on the court surface before the opponent must strike it back over the net. The player who cannot return the ball loses the point.sport-wiki+1

History of Tennis

Ancient Origins:

- Tennis originated in France in the 13th century as "jeu de paume" (game of the palm), played with hands.[scribd](#)
- Monks played early versions in monastery courtyards.

Development of Modern Tennis:

- The sport was modernized in England in the late 19th century.[scribd](#)
- Originally called "lawn tennis," it was distinguished from real tennis (indoor court tennis).[britannica](#)
- The first Wimbledon Championship was held in 1877 in London.[scribd](#)
- Tennis became an Olympic sport in 1896, was removed in 1924, and reinstated in 1988.[scribd](#)

Professional Era:

- The "Open Era" began in 1968, allowing professional players to compete in major tournaments.[scribd](#)
- The four Grand Slam tournaments (Australian Open, French Open, Wimbledon, US Open) became the sport's most prestigious events.[scribd](#)

Modern Tennis:

- Tennis is the second most popular sport in the world after football.[scribd](#)
 - Played professionally in over 200 countries.[scribd](#)
 - Governed internationally by the International Tennis Federation (ITF).[scribd](#)
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Basic Objective

Players use strung rackets to strike a hollow rubber ball covered with felt over or around a net and into the opponent's court. The ball must be kept in play and can only bounce once before the opponent must return it. Points are scored when the opponent fails to return the ball legally.[scribd](#)

Page 2: Rules, Court & Equipment

Rules of Tennis

Match Format

- **Sets:** Matches are typically best of 3 sets (women's/most tournaments) or best of 5 sets (men's Grand Slams)
- **Games:** First player to win 6 games wins the set (must win by 2 games, or play tiebreak at 6-6)
- **Points:** 0 (Love), 15, 30, 40, Game
- **Deuce:** Tied at 40-40; player must win two consecutive points to win game
- **Advantage:** Player who wins point after deuce has "advantage"
- **Tiebreak:** Played at 6-6 in a set; first to 7 points (win by 2)

Scoring System

- **Love:** 0 points
- **15:** 1 point
- **30:** 2 points
- **40:** 3 points
- **Game:** 4 points (must win by 2 after deuce)
- **Set:** 6 games (must win by 2, or win tiebreak)

- **Match:** Best of 3 or 5 sets

Service Rules

- Server stands behind baseline, between center mark and sideline
- Must serve diagonally into opponent's service box
- Two attempts allowed per point (first and second serve)
- **Fault:** Serve that doesn't land in correct service box
- **Double Fault:** Two consecutive faults = point to opponent
- **Let:** Serve that touches net but lands in correct box (replayed)
- Server alternates sides after each point
- Players alternate serving games

Playing Rules

- Ball must land within court boundaries (lines are in)
- Ball can only bounce once before return
- Player cannot touch net with body or racket
- Player cannot hit ball before it crosses net (except follow-through)
- Ball hitting any part of body = point lost
- Player cannot carry or catch ball on racket

Types of Shots

1. **Serve:** Starts each point
2. **Forehand:** Shot hit on dominant side with palm facing forward
3. **Backhand:** Shot hit on non-dominant side (one-handed or two-handed)
4. **Volley:** Shot hit before ball bounces, typically near net
5. **Overhead/Smash:** Powerful shot hit above head
6. **Drop Shot:** Soft shot that barely clears net and dies quickly
7. **Lob:** High, deep shot over opponent's head
8. **Passing Shot:** Shot hit past opponent at net

Tennis Court

Court Dimensions**[britannica](#)**

- **Length:** 78 feet (23.8 meters)
- **Width (Singles):** 27 feet (8.2 meters)**[britannica](#)**
- **Width (Doubles):** 36 feet (11.0 meters)**[britannica](#)**
- **Net Height at Center:** 3 feet (0.91 meters)**[britannica](#)**
- **Net Height at Posts:** 3.5 feet (1.1 meters)**[britannica](#)**
- **Net Posts:** Placed 3 feet outside court on each side**[britannica](#)**

Court Markings

- **Baseline:** Back boundary line
- **Singles Sidelines:** Side boundaries for singles
- **Doubles Sidelines:** Outer side boundaries for doubles
- **Service Line:** 21 feet from net
- **Center Service Line:** Divides service boxes
- **Center Mark:** Small mark on baseline

Court Surfaces**[britannica](#)+1**

1. **Grass:** Fast surface, low bounce (Wimbledon)
2. **Clay:** Slow surface, high bounce (French Open)
3. **Hard Court:** Medium speed, consistent bounce (US Open, Australian Open)
4. **Carpet:** Indoor synthetic surface (rare now)

Equipment

Tennis Racket**[dailyhunt](#)**

- **Maximum Length:** 32 inches
- **Maximum Width:** 12.5 inches
- **Striking Surface:** Flat, with pattern of crossing strings
- **String Pattern:** Generally uniform, alternately interlaced
- **Materials:** Graphite, carbon fiber, aluminum, or composite
- **Weight:** 260-340 grams (unstrung)

- **Grip Size:** Varies by player hand size

Tennis Ball[dailyhunt](#)

- **Diameter:** 2.5 to 2.625 inches (6.35-6.67 cm)
- **Weight:** 2 to 2.0625 ounces (56.7-58.5 grams)
- **Surface:** Uniform outer surface, white or yellow
- **Construction:** Hollow rubber core covered with felt
- **Pressure:** Pressurized or pressureless

Player Equipment

- **Tennis Shoes:** Designed for court traction and lateral movement
- **Tennis Apparel:** Comfortable, breathable clothing (shirts, shorts/skirts)
- **Socks:** Cushioned athletic socks
- **Optional:** Wristbands, headbands, visors/hats, sunglasses

Additional Equipment[dailyhunt](#)

- **Tennis Bag:** Designed to hold rackets, balls, and accessories
- **Grip Tape:** For racket handle customization
- **Vibration Dampeners:** Reduce racket string vibration
- **Ball Hopper:** For practice sessions

Page 3: Techniques, Competitions & Notable Players

Playing Techniques and Strategies

Serving Techniques

1. **Flat Serve:** Powerful, minimal spin
2. **Slice Serve:** Side spin, curves away from opponent
3. **Kick/Topspin Serve:** High bounce, difficult to return
4. **Body Serve:** Aimed at opponent's body

Groundstroke Techniques

1. **Topspin:** Forward rotation, high bounce, aggressive

2. **Backspin/Slice:** Backward rotation, low bounce, defensive
3. **Flat Shot:** Minimal spin, fast and direct

Net Play

- **Volley:** Hit ball before bounce
- **Half-Volley:** Hit ball immediately after bounce
- **Overhead:** Smash above head

Tactical Strategies

1. **Serve and Volley:** Serve then rush to net
 2. **Baseline Play:** Stay at baseline, hit powerful groundstrokes
 3. **Counter-Punching:** Defensive, wait for opponent errors
 4. **All-Court:** Versatile, comfortable anywhere on court
 5. **Target Weakness:** Exploit opponent's weaker side (often backhand)
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Major Competitions

Grand Slam Tournaments [scribd](#)

1. **Australian Open** (January)
 - Location: Melbourne, Australia
 - Surface: Hard court
 - First held: 1905
2. **French Open / Roland Garros** (May-June)
 - Location: Paris, France
 - Surface: Clay
 - First held: 1891
3. **Wimbledon** (June-July)
 - Location: London, England
 - Surface: Grass
 - First held: 1877 (oldest tennis tournament)
4. **US Open** (August-September)

- Location: New York, USA
- Surface: Hard court
- First held: 1881

Other Major Tournaments

- **ATP Finals:** Year-end championship for top 8 men
- **WTA Finals:** Year-end championship for top 8 women
- **Davis Cup:** Men's international team competition
- **Billie Jean King Cup:** Women's international team competition
- **ATP Masters 1000:** Nine premier men's tournaments
- **Olympic Games:** Held every 4 years

ATP and WTA Tours

- **ATP (Association of Tennis Professionals):** Men's professional tour
 - **WTA (Women's Tennis Association):** Women's professional tour
 - Rankings based on points earned over 52-week period
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Notable Players

Men's Tennis Legends

- **Roger Federer (Switzerland):** 20 Grand Slam titles, elegant playing style
- **Rafael Nadal (Spain):** 22 Grand Slam titles, "King of Clay"
- **Novak Djokovic (Serbia):** 24 Grand Slam titles, all-time record holder
- **Pete Sampras (USA):** 14 Grand Slam titles, dominant serve
- **Rod Laver (Australia):** Only player to win Calendar Grand Slam twice

Women's Tennis Legends

- **Serena Williams (USA):** 23 Grand Slam singles titles (Open Era record)
- **Steffi Graf (Germany):** 22 Grand Slam titles, Golden Slam winner
- **Martina Navratilova (USA):** 18 Grand Slam singles titles
- **Chris Evert (USA):** 18 Grand Slam singles titles
- **Margaret Court (Australia):** 24 Grand Slam singles titles (all-time record)

Current Stars

- **Men:** Novak Djokovic, Carlos Alcaraz, Jannik Sinner, Daniil Medvedev
 - **Women:** Iga Świątek, Aryna Sabalenka, Coco Gauff, Elena Rybakina
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Interesting Facts

- Tennis is the second most popular sport globally after football.[scribd](#)
 - The term "love" for zero score comes from French "l'oeuf" (egg, representing zero).[scribd](#)
 - Wimbledon is the only Grand Slam still played on grass courts.[scribd](#)
 - The fastest tennis serve ever recorded was 163.7 mph (263.4 km/h) by Sam Groth.[scribd](#)
 - A tennis match can theoretically last indefinitely (no time limit).[scribd](#)
 - The longest tennis match lasted 11 hours 5 minutes (Isner vs. Mahut, Wimbledon 2010).[scribd](#)
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Health Benefits

- Improves cardiovascular fitness and aerobic capacity
 - Develops hand-eye coordination and reflexes
 - Builds muscular strength and endurance
 - Enhances balance, agility, and flexibility
 - Burns 400-600 calories per hour of play
 - Promotes mental focus and strategic thinking
 - Social sport that can be played throughout life
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Tennis Etiquette

- Shake hands with opponent and umpire after match
- Call your own lines in recreational play (honor system)
- Apologize for net cords or lucky shots
- Don't distract opponent during play

- Return balls promptly to server
- Maintain appropriate noise levels during points